

Maternity, Paternity and Parental Leave Policy

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1. Purpose

Zuqah Technologies recognises that becoming a parent is a significant life event. This policy describes the leave and support available to employees who are expecting, adopting or welcoming a new child, and sets out the company's commitments during and after parental leave.

2. Maternity leave

2.1 Entitlement

Maternity leave is provided in accordance with the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 (as amended in 2017).

Circumstance	Paid leave entitlement
First or second child	26 weeks
Third child or more	12 weeks
Adoption of a child below 3 months of age	12 weeks from the date of adoption
Commissioning mother (surrogacy)	12 weeks from birth of child

Leave may begin up to 8 weeks before the expected date of delivery. The remaining leave is available after delivery.

2.2 Pay during maternity leave

Maternity leave is fully paid at the employee's regular salary for the applicable period. This pay is provided by Zuqah Technologies and is separate from any statutory benefits the employee may be entitled to.

2.3 Miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy

An employee who suffers a miscarriage or undergoes a medical termination of pregnancy is entitled to 6 weeks of paid leave from the date of the event, supported by a medical certificate.

2.4 Illness arising from pregnancy

If an employee suffers an illness arising from pregnancy or delivery, additional paid leave of up to 1 month may be granted on production of a medical certificate.

2.5 Nursing breaks

After returning from maternity leave, an employee is entitled to two breaks of 15 minutes each per working day to nurse her child, until the child is 15 months old. These breaks are in addition to the regular lunch break and are paid.

2.6 Crèche

Zuqah Technologies will either provide or arrange access to a crèche facility, as required under the Maternity Benefit Act for employers with 50 or more employees. Where the company does not yet meet this threshold, it will provide reasonable support to help employees with childcare arrangements.

2.7 Work from home after maternity leave

Where the nature of the role permits, an employee returning from maternity leave may request a temporary or permanent work-from-home arrangement. Such requests will be considered under the Flexible Working Arrangements Policy.

2.8 Protection from dismissal

An employee may not be dismissed, discharged or have their service terminated during the period of maternity leave, or in connection with her pregnancy. Any order of dismissal during this period is void.

3. Paternity leave

3.1 Entitlement

Zuqah Technologies provides 10 working days of paid paternity leave to employees whose partner has given birth or adopted a child below the age of 5 years.

This leave is in addition to the employee's regular annual leave.

3.2 When to take it

Paternity leave must be taken within 3 months of the birth or adoption. It can be taken in one block or split into two periods, by agreement with the manager.

3.3 Pay during paternity leave

Paternity leave is fully paid at the employee's regular salary.

4. Adoption leave

4.1 Primary adopter

An employee who is the primary adopter of a child below the age of 3 months is entitled to 12 weeks of paid leave, beginning from the date of adoption. (Note: employees who adopt a child aged 3 months or older are entitled to paternity leave as applicable.)

4.2 Secondary adopter

The employee who is the secondary adopter in an adoption is entitled to 10 working days of paid adoption leave, to be taken within 3 months of the adoption.

5. Shared parental leave

Parents may discuss with People Operations whether responsibilities during the statutory maternity or adoption period can be shared between them. People Operations will advise on the arrangements

available under applicable law at the time of the request.

6. How to apply

6.1 Notice requirements

Leave type	Notice required
Maternity leave	At least 8 weeks before the expected date of leave
Paternity leave	At least 2 weeks before the expected leave date
Adoption leave	As soon as reasonably possible after adoption is confirmed

Notice should be given in writing to the employee's manager, with a copy to People Operations.

6.2 Documentation required

Leave type	Documentation
Maternity leave	Medical certificate stating expected date of delivery
Miscarriage / termination leave	Medical certificate
Adoption leave	Proof of adoption (court order or adoption agency confirmation)

6.3 Keeping in touch

During maternity or adoption leave, employees may, by mutual agreement with their manager, work up to 10 Keeping in Touch (KIT) days without losing their parental leave entitlement. KIT days are paid at the employee's normal daily rate and are used for activities such as training, project meetings or handover.

KIT days are voluntary and must not be required by the manager.

7. Return to work

7.1 Right to return

An employee returning from parental leave has the right to return to the same role on the same terms and conditions. If the role no longer exists due to a restructuring, the employee must be offered a suitable alternative role on terms no less favourable.

7.2 Phased return

Employees returning from maternity or adoption leave of 12 weeks or more may request a phased return to full-time hours over a period of up to 4 weeks. The phased return is paid at full salary.

7.3 Flexible working request

Any employee returning from maternity, paternity or adoption leave may make a request for flexible working under the Flexible Working Arrangements Policy. Such requests made on return from parental leave will be considered with particular care.

8. Benefits during leave

During paid parental leave, all benefits continue as normal, including health insurance, PF contributions and any other benefits the employee is enrolled in.

Annual leave continues to accrue during the full period of maternity or adoption leave.

9. Period leave (menstrual leave)

In recognition that menstruation can cause significant discomfort, Zuqah Technologies provides 2 days of paid period leave per month to employees who experience menstrual symptoms. This is in addition to regular sick leave and annual leave entitlements.

Period leave does not require a medical certificate and does not need to be explained in detail. Employees should mark the leave in the HR system as "period leave" and inform their manager they will be absent.

Period leave is provided in addition to, not instead of, sick leave.

10. Contact

For questions about this policy or to notify Zuqah Technologies of a pregnancy or adoption:

People Operations: people@zuqahtechnologies.com

Sample content for demonstration purposes. Zuqah Technologies is a fictional company and this document describes no real organisation's policy.